THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Source: 'The bones of the cotton weavers are bleaching the plains of India.' The speaker refers to 1

(a) a festival **(b)** collapse of the textile industry
(c) a flood **(d)** a battle

2. Planters forcing peasants to grow indigo at low rates leads to 1

(a) prosperity **(b)** wealth **(c)** debt and revolt **(d)** peace

3. If the Governor-General annexes a state by saying it is badly governed, he uses 1

(a) Subsidiary only **(b)** Lapse
(c) the charge of misrule **(d)** Cartaz

4. A ruler dies with no natural son but has adopted one. Under Lapse the British would 1

(a) leave it **(b)** annex the state
(c) give gold **(d)** recognise the heir

5. The Battle of Colachel is significant because 1

(a) it was fought in Delhi
(b) an Indian kingdom defeated a European power
(c) Europeans won
(d) British lost Bengal

6. A tax collector demands full payment despite a failed harvest. The likely result is 1

(a) surplus **(b)** peace
(c) rich farmers **(d)** debt, hunger and unrest

7. A treaty makes a ruler pay for British troops stationed in his kingdom. This is the 1

(a) Dewani **(b)** Doctrine of Lapse
(c) Cartaz **(d)** Subsidiary Alliance

8. Dupleix's use of sepoys influenced the British because 1

(a) they ignored it **(b)** they joined France
(c) they banned it **(d)** they adopted the practice

9. **Assertion (A):** The Portuguese captured Goa in 1510 under Albuquerque. 1
Reason (R): Vasco da Gama had reached Kappad near Kozhikode in 1498.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** After the Battle of Plassey (1757), Mir Jafar became the Nawab of Bengal. 1
Reason (R): Mir Jafar had conspired with Clive against Siraj-ud-daulah.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. 'Bones of cotton weavers' remark: what does it tell about the economy? 2

12. Why do historians check sources by European officers carefully? 2

13. Why did peasants fear indigo cultivation? 2

14. Why is the Doctrine of Lapse called unfair? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Source: 'India's share in world GDP fell from one-fourth to about 5 per cent.' Give three causes. 3

16. Compare the strategies of Dupleix and Clive. 3

17. Argue why village councils' decline hurt Indian society. 3

OR

Case: A ruler without a son adopts an heir and dies; the British annex his state. Identify the policy and an example. 3

18. Assess the importance of Colachel in global history. 3

OR

Examine how the British used religion and caste to divide Indians after 1857. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** In 1770 Bengal suffered a terrible famine, yet the Company continued to demand heavy land revenue. About one-third of Bengal's population is said to have died. During another Great Famine of 1876-78, under Viceroy Lord Lytton, grain was still being exported from India. 5
(i) What share of Bengal's population died in 1770?
(ii) Who was the Viceroy during 1876-78?
(iii) Name the author of 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India'.
(iv) How did colonial policies make famines worse?

20. Evaluate the Subsidiary Alliance and the Doctrine of Lapse as tools of expansion. 5

OR

Case study: A district sees railway lines built to the port while local markets decline. Analyse the colonial economy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks